Ford Motor Company

September 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: **DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD:** Safety Recall 00S25: Certain 2001 Model Year 4x2 Escape Vehicles – Rear Wheel Hub Inspection

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2001 model year 4x2 Escape vehicles without ABS option built at the Kansas City Assembly plant from October 27, 1999 through August 28, 2000.

SAFETY CONCERN

A limited number of the affected 4x2 vehicles may have been built with 4x4 rear wheel hubs. This misbuild condition may cause the rear wheels to become loose or separate from the vehicle. This could adversely affect vehicle control and could potentially lead to a vehicle crash.

SERVICE ACTION

Do not drive, demonstrate, deliver or perform pre-delivery inspection **on any vehicles affected by this recall until this inspection has been performed.**

Dealers can perform a visual inspection to determine if a vehicle is affected by this concern, simply by removing the wheel cap and checking the center of the hub for the presence of a through-hole. Vehicles with a through-hole in the hub are misbuilt. Refer to Attachment III for the complete inspection procedure.

Customers who have taken delivery of their vehicles will also be given inspection instructions. At their option, these customers may contact the dealer to have this inspection performed and, if the vehicle fails the inspection, the dealer is to transport the vehicle to the dealership for repair. These customers are also eligible for a rental car until the unit is repaired.

Of the total population of approximately 1600 vehicles subject to inspection, potentially two or three units are expected to exhibit this misbuild condition. In either inspection situation, if a vehicle is identified with the misbuild condition, it must only be transported on roll-back style wrecker. It may not be driven or towed. These units must be held until service repair instructions and parts requirements can be developed.

Check QCDealer.com for updates. If you find a vehicle with this condition, please call the Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621. Dealers should be aware that special handling of the customer's vehicle is requested, and dealers will be reimbursed to wash, vacuum and re-fill the vehicle with fuel after the service is complete.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

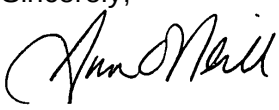
ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Attachment IV: Escape Special Handling Letter
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S25
Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles
4x2 Rear Wheel Hub Inspection

OASIS

OASIS will be activated for this Safety Recall. You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles that are brought to your dealership.

Do not drive, demonstrate, deliver or perform pre-delivery inspection **on any vehicles affected by this recall until this inspection has been performed.**

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date. Because these vehicles have been subject to other 'stop sale' notifications, it is anticipated that few, if any, vehicles have been delivered to customers. If you are aware of any pre-sale units, contact these customers immediately.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner cannot be contacted or does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

RENTAL CARS

Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle, except for fuel, which will be at the customer's expense. Enter the word "LOANER" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area. See 'Escape Special Handling Procedure', Attachment IV.

TOWING (VEHICLE RECOVERY)

In cases where the vehicle must be picked-up at the customer's location and returned to the dealership for repair, dealers may claim towing on the Recall Claim. Use Miscellaneous Expense "TOW" with the actual amount billed. If a vehicle is identified with the misbuild condition, it must only be transported on a roll-back style wrecker.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S25
Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles
4x2 Rear Wheel Hub Inspection

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Inspect Rear Wheel Hub Assembly	00S25A	0.2 Hours
Install 4x2 Rear Hub Assembly	Currently Under Development. Procedure to be released in Supplement week of September 25, 2000.	
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Of the approximate 1600 vehicles subject to inspection, potentially two or three will likely require 4x2 hub installation. Dealers must call the Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621 when encountering any vehicle that fails the inspection procedure and requires repair.

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

ATTACHMENT IV

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S25
Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles
4x2 Rear Wheel Hub Inspection

Escape Special Handling

If Dealer <u>Picks up and Returns Vehicle</u> for Customer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
• Pick up the customer's vehicle with a **roll-back style wrecker** (at a location of their preference such as home or place of business) and return after repair* • Drop off comparable loaner vehicle • Refill fuel tank • Wash and vacuum vehicle • Return vehicle to customer after repair is completed	Up to 2 hours additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum Note: Labor time to fill tank and wash/vacuum has been included in 2 hour allowance Labor subject to time recording procedures as outlined in Warranty & Policy Manual	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP" EXAMPLE (using example labor rate of $62.36/hour and fuel cost of $1.50/gallon): 1.0 hrs. labor* = $62.36 9.0 gals fuel = 13.50 <u>Wash/vacuum = 10.00</u> Total Submitted = $85.86 *Travel time plus fueling/washing labor.
Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer when vehicle is picked up	Actual cost up to a maximum up to $28 per day for a Ford rental. (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 30 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization)
Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin	See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin

*Or repair on-site if appropriate; if on-site repair is performed, rental charges do not apply.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673

September 2000

00S25

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 2001 model year two-wheel drive Escape vehicles.

What the safety issue is….

Some of the affected two-wheel drive vehicles may have inadvertently been built with four-wheel drive rear wheel hubs. This misbuild condition could allow the rear wheels to become loose or separate from the vehicle. If the rear wheel separates, it could adversely affect vehicle control, which could potentially result in a vehicle crash.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do...

Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to perform an immediate safety inspection of the rear hub (with the wheel cap removed) or, at your option, contact your dealer, who will perform the inspection for you.

If the misbuild condition exists, **DO NOT DRIVE THE VEHICLE.** Please contact your nearest dealer for pick-up and installation of the correct two-wheel drive rear hub assembly.

How long will it take?

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns…

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Assistance Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 (Washington, D. C. area residents may call 1-202-366-0123).

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

ESCAPE REAR HUB INSPECTION

AFFECTED VEHICLES: CERTAIN 2001 ESCAPE 2-WHEEL DRIVE MODELS

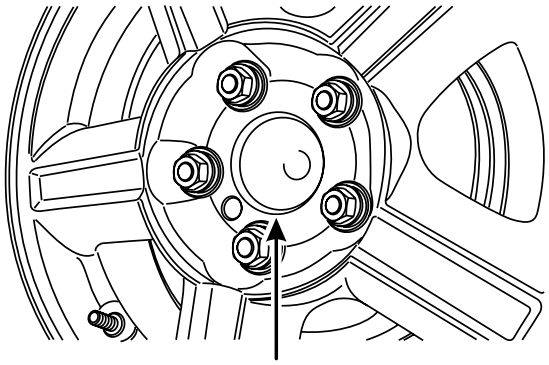
OVERVIEW

A small number of Escape 2-Wheel Drive models may have been incorrectly assembled with 4-Wheel Drive rear wheel hubs. This inspection procedure may be performed by your dealer, if you so desire. If you choose to perform the inspection yourself, the following procedure will instruct you on where to look and how to identify the rear hubs on your vehicle.

WARNING: IF YOU DISCOVER 4-WHEEL DRIVE REAR WHEEL HUB(S) INSTALLED ON YOUR VEHICLE, DO NOT DRIVE THE VEHICLE. CALL YOUR DEALER TO ARRANGE TO HAVE YOUR ESCAPE PICKED UP FOR SERVICE TO REPLACE THE HUBS WITH THE CORRECT COMPONENTS.

INSPECTION

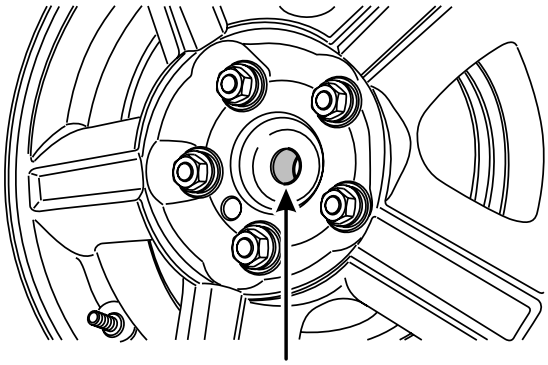
1. Using the factory-supplied tire wrench or a wide flat-blade screwdriver, carefully remove the hub caps from both rear wheels.
2. Inspect to see if a 2-Wheel Drive or a 4-Wheel hub has been installed. See Figures 1 and 2.
   - The 2-Wheel Drive hub can be identified by the deep concave-shaped casting in the center.
   - The 4-Wheel Drive hub can be identified by a shallow center casting with a 1-inch diameter hole bored through the very center of it.



DEEP CONCAVE-SHAPED CASTING

2-WHEEL DRIVE HUB CORRECT

FIGURE 1



SHALLOW CENTER CASTING WITH 1" DIAMETER HOLE

4-WHEEL DRIVE HUB INCORRECT

00S25CVA

FIGURE 2

3. Determine the repair needs.
   - If your vehicle is equipped with 2-Wheel Drive hubs on both sides of the vehicle, no replacement is necessary. Reinstall the hub caps. Your vehicle is safe to drive.
   - If your vehicle is equipped with a 4-Wheel Drive hub on either or both sides, the hub and bearing assemblies must be replaced. **DO NOT DRIVE THE VEHICLE.** CALL YOUR DEALER TO ARRANGE TO HAVE YOUR ESCAPE PICKED UP FOR SERVICE TO REPLACE THE HUBS WITH THE CORRECT COMPONENTS.

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DEARBORN, MICHIGAN 48121
09/00